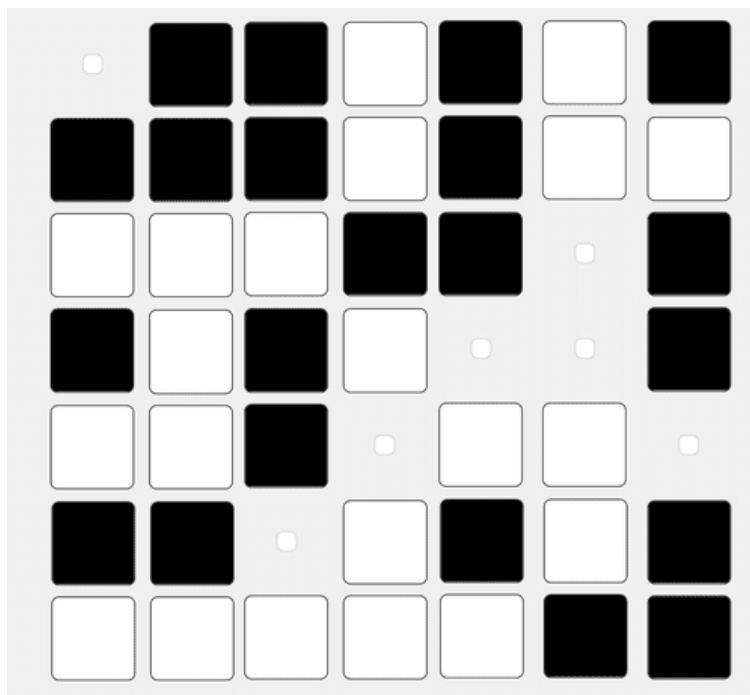


Piksi

2026, Mark S. Ball, <https://boardgamegeek.com/thread/3724914>



Player 1 randomly distributes the 42 cubes out on the board. Player 2 then chooses which color they will play as (black or white). Player 1 goes first.

On your turn, you must be able to complete a two-step sequence: a Pick and a Slide.

The Pick. Select one cube of your own color from the board and remove it (it is now out of play). The piece you pick must have at least two orthogonally adjacent neighbors.

The Slide. The removal of your piece creates a single empty space. This space must be filled immediately. Select one cube of either color that was orthogonally adjacent (up, down, left, or right) to the picked piece and slide it into the space.

If a player is unable to complete a turn, the game ends immediately.

The last player to pick and slide wins.

Designer notes. So, Piksi started out as an impartial game. 24 same colored pieces on a 5x5 grid with a randomized empty space. The "must have two orthogonally adjacent neighbors" rule is a carryover from that setup. It was an attempt to force people to pick certain pieces rather than just peck away at the edges. Once I made the game partisan, I eventually added neutral pieces, and that combined with the neighbor rule made for some interesting situations like the ghost captures.

The question that initiated this design was: could I make a Konane-like with no jumping? Originally, it was the last player able to complete a turn that would win, but going partisan with most captures winning was much more exciting. Piksi is about positioning and isolating. You can isolate your own pieces and collect them. Do that too much and you will run out of turns which allows your opponent to sweep what is left. The quicker you run out of gas, the more pieces are left on the board for your opponent to sweep.

Originally there was only one red cube added. Once I realized the red cubes could be a neutral resource that players fought over, and the potential they created for ghost captures, I added more to the layout.

I use the term cube because I imagine the setup to be like Boggle. Put the lid on the box, give it a good shake, and remove the lid. I thought the randomized setup would add the same flavor as Chess 960. This calls for players to be able to evaluate the initial setup. Red pieces that are surrounded by a single color are already under the influence of that player. Corner pieces are important too, but I am still figuring out how best to use them.